

Additional Journal Approval After Cutoff Date

Cloud ERP Applications Development

July 2025, Version 1.6

Copyright © 2025, Oracle and/or its affiliates

Public

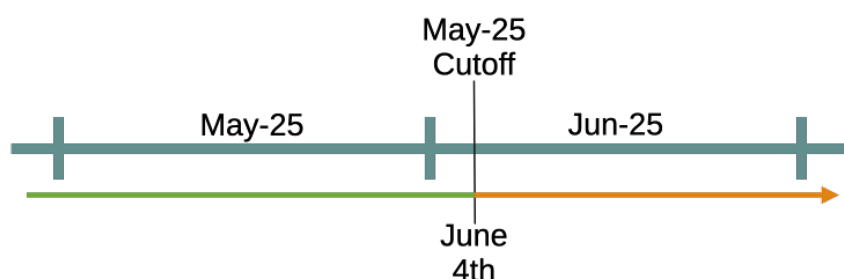
Introduction

As period close nears, many enterprises impose restrictions on manual adjustment journals. After a specific business day or cutoff date, journals require an additional review and approval by a senior manager or designated team. The policy permits reconciliation and consolidation activities to commence without preventing exceptional and essential balance adjustments.

This document illustrates a BPM Worklist configuration that sends journals for an additional level of approval if submitted or approved after an accounting period's cutoff date. The approach relies on BPM Worklist rules that compare a date & time stored in a descriptive flexfield (DFF) with today's date & time.

Sample Use Case

Typically, an accounting period's cutoff date falls two or three business days after the end of the month. Prior to the cutoff date, a single level of approval suffices. After the cutoff date, workflow directs the journal to an additional approver.



For journals entered into the May-25 accounting period:

- Submitted or approved in May - require no additional approval.
- Submitted or approved in June prior to the cutoff on June 4th – require no additional approval.
- Submitted or approved in June after the cutoff on June 4th – require additional approval.

Journals submitted or approved in May for the Jun-25 accounting period require no additional approval.

The use case assumes that both May-25 and Jun-25 accounting periods remain open while the journals are created and approved.

Step 1 – Request Access to BPM Worklist Configuration

Since 23B, new customers have been directed to the Manage Workflow Rules in Spreadsheet task to define approval rules for Financials transactions. The approval rules described in this document rely on BPM Worklist features unavailable to the spreadsheet.

Customers who wish to implement an additional approval after cutoff should log a support request (SR) requesting we enable BPM Worklist configuration in their environments. The SR should detail the business requirement and why the spreadsheet feature cannot address it. Support and ERP development will review the SR and, if approved, provide a mechanism to enable BPM Worklist rule configuration.

Step 2 – Define an Accounting Period DFF to Store the Cutoff Date

Extend the Accounting Period page to record each period's cutoff date using a DFF.

Date Formats and Timezones

To cater for the time of day and timezone, you should define the DFF using the character format Attribute 1...5 Table Columns. Assign it a generic character value set. The user that records each month's cutoff date and time in the calendar must adhere to the specified format. This sample configuration uses the ISO_LOCAL_DATE_TIME

format since it requires no further conversion in the workflow approval rules. The format in SQL would be yyyy-mm-ddThh24:mi:ss. For example, 2025-06-04T18:30:00 corresponds to June 4th, 2025, at 6:30pm. You can guide the user to enter the correct format using the prompt and help text.

By default, the BPM worklist evaluates dates and times using the [Coordinated Universal Time \(UTC\)](#) timezone. You can specify a timezone for the cutoff date by appending @[TimeZoneID](#) to the ISO_LOCAL_DATE_TIME format. For example, 2025-06-04T18:30:00@PST corresponds to June 4th, 2025, at 6:30pm in Pacific Standard Time.

If your enterprise has adopted a global UTC cutoff date, you can store it in one of the DFF Date Attribute 1...5 Table Columns. Assign it one of the seeded date format value sets to ensure that the user enters a valid date.

In Setup and Maintenance, navigate to the Manage General Ledger Descriptive Flexfields task. Search for Accounting Calendar Periods in the Name field.

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Segment' form in Oracle Vision. The form is titled 'Edit Segment' with a help icon. It contains several sections: 'Flexfield Name' (Accounting Calendar Periods), 'Flexfield Code' (GL_PERIODS), 'Name' (Cutoff Date and Time), 'Code' (Cutoff_Date), 'API Name' (cutoffDateTime), 'Description' (empty), 'Enabled' (checked), 'Column Assignment' (Data Type: Character, Table Column: ATTRIBUTE1), 'Validation' (Value Set: 30 Characters, Value Set Description: 30 Characters, no validation, Range Type: dropdown, Required: unchecked), 'Initial Default' (Default Type: dropdown), 'Display Properties' (Prompt: Cutoff (eg 2025-08-24T18:30:00), Display Type: Text Box, Display Size: input, Display Height: input, Read-only: unchecked), 'Definition Help Text' (For example, enter 2025-08-24T18:30:00), 'Instruction Help Text' (Specifies the manual adjustment cutoff date for this month), 'Business Intelligence' (BI Enabled: unchecked, BI Label: dropdown), and action buttons (Save, Save and Close, Cancel).

All accounting calendars will display the DFF. If you have countries or divisions with different close schedules and hence, cutoff dates, you can define up to four additional descriptive flexfields to store them.

Note that creating additional calendars to accommodate many different cutoff dates and times may impact other aspects of the enterprise structure design. For example, ledger sets cannot include ledgers with different calendars.

Once the setup is complete, deploy the descriptive flexfield. Remember to sign out and sign back in again to use it.

Step 3 – Record the Cutoff Date for Each Accounting Period

In Setup and Maintenance, navigate to the Manage Accounting Calendars task. The cutoff date will appear as an additional field.

≡

vision

Edit Accounting Calendar: AccountingMMYY

2

🔍

🏠

☆

🚩

🔔

25

Save

Save and Close

Cancel

* Name

AccountingMMYY

— Budgetary control only

Adjusting Period Frequency

Once at year end

Format

MMYY calendar year

Description

Standard January to December and 1 Adj. period at year end (Numeric period names)

First Period

01-29

Start Date

1/1/10

Period Frequency

Monthly

Period Details

View

📅

🔍

Add Year

Year

2025

m/d/yyyy

m/d/yyyy

Period Name

Year

Period Number

Quarter Number

Start Date

End Date

Adjusting Period

Additional Information

Cutoff (eg 2025-08-24T18:30:00)

▶	01-25	2025	1	1	1/1/25	1/31/25	—	2025-02-04T18:30:00
▶	02-25	2025	2	1	2/1/25	2/28/25	—	2025-03-03T18:30:00
▶	03-25	2025	3	1	3/1/25	3/31/25	—	2025-04-05T18:30:00
▶	04-25	2025	4	2	4/1/25	4/30/25	—	2025-05-05T18:30:00
▶	05-25	2025	5	2	5/1/25	5/31/25	—	2025-06-04T19:30:00
▶	06-25	2025	6	2	6/1/25	6/30/25	—	2025-07-05T18:30:00
▶	07-25	2025	7	3	7/1/25	7/31/25	—	2025-08-03T18:30:00
▶	08-25	2025	8	3	8/1/25	8/31/25	—	
▶	09-25	2025	9	3	9/1/25	9/30/25	—	
▶	10-25	2025	10	4	10/1/25	10/31/25	—	
▶	11-25	2025	11	4	11/1/25	11/30/25	—	
▶	12-25	2025	12	4	12/1/25	12/31/25	—	
▶	Adj-25	2025	13	4	12/31/25	12/31/25	✓	

Take care to enter the cutoff date in the specified format with or without the timezone suffix. The approval workflow will error if it encounters an incorrectly formatted date.

Step 4 – Configure the Approval Rules

In Setup and Maintenance, navigate to the Manage Task Configurations for Financials task. Search for the FinGJournalApproval task.

Create two sequential participants.

- Primary: represents your business specific rules for the first approval.
- Escalation After Cutoff: add a sequential participant to capture the conditions and approver(s) for journals submitted or approved after the cutoff date and time.

The approval rules rely on a distinction between two sets of attributes made available to BPM by Cloud GL.

- Period: attributes of the journal’s accounting period.
- Submitted Period: attributes of the accounting period that includes the date the user submitted the journal for approval.

For a journal submitted for approval on June 2nd in the May-25 accounting period, the Period is May-25, and the Submitted Period is Jun-25.

The screenshot shows the Oracle BPM Worklist interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Administration', 'Evidence Search', 'Approval Groups', and 'Task Configuration'. The left sidebar shows 'Tasks to be configured' with a search for 'journal' and results for 'FinGIJournalApproval' and 'FinGIJournalApprovalErrorFyi'. The main area is titled 'Assignees' and shows a process flow diagram with a 'Primary' task and an 'EscalationAfterCutoff' task. Below the diagram, the 'EscalationAfterCutoff' task configuration is shown, including 'Basic' and 'Advanced' tabs, a dropdown for 'Assignees based on' set to 'Rule-based', and a 'Business rule' dropdown set to 'EscalationAfterCutoff'.

For this use case, we created four rules for the Escalation After Cutoff participant. The rules necessary to address your detailed enterprise specific requirements will no doubt vary. The examples illustrate how BPM Worklist supports comparing a date and time stored in a character format descriptive flexfield (DFF) with today's date and time.

Rule 1: SkipSamePeriodJournal

Don't escalate journals whose accounting period and submitted accounting period match. For example, a journal submitted in May for the May-25 accounting period, does not require a second approval.

Condition: `Period.Name is Submitted Period.Name`

Action: `call IgnoreParticipant_V2 ("SkipSamePeriodJournal ", null)`

The screenshot shows the Oracle BPM Worklist interface for configuring rules. The left sidebar shows 'Rules' and 'Value Sets'. The main area is titled 'Rules' and shows a list of rules: 'SkipSamePeriodJournal', 'SkipFuturePeriodJournal', 'SkipPreviousPeriodApprovedBeforeCutoff', and 'Escalation'. The 'SkipSamePeriodJournal' rule is selected, and its properties are shown on the right. The rule is defined as an 'IF' condition: `Period.Name is Submitted Period.Name`. The 'THEN' action is `call IgnoreParticipant_V2 ("SkipSamePeriodJournal", null)`.

Rule 2: SkipFuturePeriodJournal

Don't escalate journals submitted for a future accounting period. For example, a journal submitted in May for the Jun-25 accounting period, does not require a second approval.

Condition:

Period.Start Date.toGregorianCalendar() **more than** Submitted Period.End Date.toGregorianCalendar()

Action: **call** IgnoreParticipant_V2 ("SkipFuturePeriodJournal", null)

The screenshot shows the 'Rules' configuration page for the rule 'SkipFuturePeriodJournal'. The left sidebar contains navigation links: General, Assignees, Data, Deadlines, Notifications, Access, and Configuration. The main area has tabs for Rules, Value Sets, Globals, and Advanced. The 'Rules' tab is active, showing a list of rules with 'SkipFuturePeriodJournal' selected. The rule configuration is displayed on the right, showing an 'IF' condition: 'Period.Start Date.toGregorianCalendar() more than Submitted Period.End Date.toGregorianCalendar()'. The 'THEN' section shows an action: 'call IgnoreParticipant_V2 ("SkipFuturePeriodJournal", null)'. A 'Validate' button is in the top right corner.

Note: BPM doesn't support directly comparing start and end date fields. The toGregorianCalendar() function converts them into a format that can be compared.

Rule 3: SkipPreviousPeriodApprovedBeforeCutoffTime

Don't escalate journals for the previous accounting period submitted prior to the cutoff date. For example, a journal submitted on June 2nd for the May-25 accounting period, does not require a second approval.

Condition: Submitted Period.Name **isn't** Period.Name and

(

Period.End Date.toGregorianCalendar() **less than** Submitted Period.Start Date.toGregorianCalendar() and

Calendar.getInstance().getTimelnMillis() **same or less than** JavaDate.from datetime string(Period.Descriptive Flexfield Attribute 1).getTimelnMillis()

)

Action: **call** IgnoreParticipant_V2 ("SkipPreviousPeriodApprovedBeforeCutoffTime", null)

The screenshot shows the 'Rules' configuration page for the rule 'SkipPreviousPeriodApprovedBeforeCutoffTime'. The left sidebar contains navigation links: BPM Worklist, General, Assignees, Data, Deadlines, Notifications, Access, and Configuration. The main area has tabs for Rules, Value Sets, Globals, and Advanced. The 'Rules' tab is active, showing a list of rules with 'SkipPreviousPeriodApprovedBeforeCutoffTime' selected. The rule configuration is displayed on the right, showing an 'IF' condition: 'Submitted Period.Name isn't Period.Name and the following test is true'. The test is a logical AND of two conditions: 'Period.End Date.toGregorianCalendar() less than Submitted Period.Start Date.toGregorianCalendar()' and 'Calendar.getInstance().getTimelnMillis() same or less than JavaDate.from datetime string(Period.Descriptive Flexfield Attribute 1).getTimelnMillis()'. The 'THEN' section shows an action: 'call IgnoreParticipant_V2 ("SkipPreviousPeriodApprovedBeforeCutoffTime", null)'. A 'Validate' button is in the top right corner.

If a date format DFF column stores the cutoff date, change the condition line...

Calendar.getInstance().getTimelnMillis() same or less than JavaDate.from datetime string(Period.Descriptive Flexfield Attribute 1).getTimelnMillis()

to...

Duration.days between(CurrentDate.date, Period.Descriptive Flexfield Date 1.toGregorianCalendar()) same or more than 0

Rule 4: Escalation

Escalate journals for the previous accounting period submitted after the cutoff date. For example, a journal submitted on June 10th for the May-25 accounting period, requires a second approval.

Condition: Submitted Period.Name isn't Period.Name and

(

Calendar.getInstance().getTimelnMillis() more than JavaDate.from datetime string(Period.Descriptive Flexfield Attribute 1).getTimelnMillis() and

Period.End Date.toGregorianCalendar() less than Submitted Period.Start Date.toGregorianCalendar()

)

Action: direct the journal to the second approver

The screenshot shows the Oracle BPM Worklist interface for configuring a rule named 'EscalationAfterCutoff'. The left sidebar contains navigation icons for General, Assignees, Data, Deadlines, Notifications, Access, and Configuration. The main area displays the rule configuration under the 'Rules' tab. The rule is currently in 'Escalation' mode. The condition is defined as: 'Submitted Period.Name isn't Period.Name and the following test is true'. The test consists of two parts: 'Calendar.getInstance().getTimelnMillis() more than JavaDate.from datetime string(Period.Descriptive Flexfield Attribute 1).getTimelnMillis() and Period.End Date.toGregorianCalendar() less than Submitted Period.Start Date.toGregorianCalendar()'. The 'THEN' section is configured with a 'List Builder' resource, a 'Required' response type, and specific users ('james.bird') and groups (null) for participants. The application role is set to 'null', and the rule name is 'Escalation'.

If a date format DFF column stores the cutoff date, change the condition line...

Calendar.getInstance().getTimelnMillis() more than JavaDate.from datetime string(Period.Descriptive Flexfield Attribute 1).getTimelnMillis()

to...

Duration.days between(CurrentDate.date, Period.Descriptive Flexfield Date 1.toGregorianCalendar()) less than 0

Useful Link

[Oracle Business Rules Built-in Classes and Functions](#) appendix of the Designing Business Rules with Oracle Business Process Management book lists BPM Worklist functions.

Results

June's cutoff date is June 4th. Casey Brown submitted Journal NMR-4 on June 9th for the May-25 accounting period. Since the journal was submitted after the cutoff date, BPM sends the journal for an additional approval.

vision

< Journal Approval : NMR-4

Actions

View Transaction History

Status: In Progress

Submitted On: 6/9/25

Process Name: Journal Approval

Submitted By: Casey Brown

Transaction ID: NMR-4, 300000305882534

Diagnostic Log

Download

Approval History

Approvals

Assigned to James Bird

6/9/25 10:02 AM

Approved by Anita Kennedy

6/9/25 10:02 AM

Submitted by Casey Brown

6/9/25 10:00 AM

Comments and Attachments

No data to display.

Issue Comments

User Name

No data to display.

After setting June's cutoff date to June 10th, Casey Brown submitted journal NMR-5 on June 9th for the May-25 accounting period. Since the journal was submitted before the cutoff date, a single approval suffices.

vision

< Journal Approval : NMR-5

View Transaction History

Status: Completed

Submitted On: 6/9/25

Process Name: Journal Approval

Submitted By: Casey Brown

Transaction ID: NMR-5, 300000305882541

Diagnostic Log

Download

Approval History

Approvals

Approved by Anita Kennedy

6/9/25 10:18 AM

Submitted by Casey Brown

6/9/25 10:17 AM

Comments and Attachments

No data to display.

Issue Comments

User Name

No data to display.

Journal Not Approved Until After Cutoff Date

The following test demonstrates that BPM sends a journal submitted prior to the cutoff date, but not approved until after it, to a second approver.

We changed the cutoff date to 2025-06-09T19:30:00 (June 9th at 7:30pm). The user submits journal NMR-7 on June 9th at 3:59pm for the May-25 accounting period. Hence, when submitted for approval, a single approver suffices.

vision

Journal Approval : NMR-7

Actions View Transaction History

Status: In Progress
Process Name: Journal Approval
Transaction ID: NMR-7, 300000305995557

Submitted On: 6/9/25
Submitted By: Casey Brown
Diagnostic Log Download

Approval History

Approvals

Assigned to Anita Kennedy 6/9/25 3:59 PM

Submitted by Casey Brown 6/9/25 3:59 PM

Comments and Attachments

No data to display.

Issue Comments

User Name

No data to display.

Anita Kennedy approves the journal on June 10th. Since the approval occurs after the cutoff, BPM sends the journal to an additional approver.

vision

Journal Approval : NMR-7

Actions View Transaction History

Status: In Progress
Process Name: Journal Approval
Transaction ID: NMR-7, 300000305995557

Submitted On: 6/9/25
Submitted By: Casey Brown
Diagnostic Log Download

Approval History

Approvals

Assigned to James Bird 6/10/25 8:24 AM

Approved by Anita Kennedy 6/10/25 8:24 AM

Submitted by Casey Brown 6/9/25 3:59 PM

Comments and Attachments

No data to display.

Issue Comments

User Name

No data to display.

Conclusion

BPM supports escalation of journals entered late in the period close cycle to additional approvers. Adapt this solution to your enterprise specific business requirements.